

SECURE YOUR ANDROID, IOS AND WINDOWS DEVICE

Our digital devices aren't a mere access to digital gateways anymore, but also store a lot of our private data. We need to ensure that we take proper precautionary measures to safeguard our private data. There are a few critical methods to achieve better privacy on your Android, iOS and Windows devices. Let's take a look at each of them.

Enable Two-Factor authentication (2FA)

Two-factor authentication or two-step verification is a security process which takes into account two different identification parameters. Only then a successful authentication can be established. The essential identification credentials can be a password or PIN, a physical device (phone or USB stick) and your physical characteristic (fingerprint or voice). Two out of these three credentials

are required for Two-factor authentication. It is quite difficult for attackers to extract the credentials since having access to a user's password won't be enough. This feature is what adds extra security over conventional authentication processes. But 2FA doesn't ensure absolute security and users have to carry a physical device with them. However practicing 2FA

will still be better than Single-Factor authentication. 2FA can be implemented across different platforms for mobile devices to ensure the integrity of the consumer's identity.

Android

Google provides 2FA authentication to its users across a variety of its products, Android being one of them. Users can

enable two-step verification by logging into their Google accounts and set it up through My Accounts > Sign-In & Security. Then click on 2-step verification to turn it on. Google will now ask for the medium through which you would like to get your verification codes on your device – voice call or text message. Enter the verification code you've received and then finally you'll be able to confirm activation. You can also use the Google Authenticator app for generating verification codes. Now whenever you login from an untrusted device, after you enter your email and password, a security code will be sent to your registered device. In case, you don't have your phone to receive the generated code, you can use the Backup Codes generated anytime.

iOS

To activate two-factor authentication on an iOS device you need to go to the Apple website. Then go to Apple ID Settings > Manage your Apple ID. Login



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Select Text message to receive codes on your phone

Login into your Apple ID to activate two-factor authentication

Remember the verification code displayed in the earlier step

Click on Get Started to start with the 2-step verification